

A medieval knight with a long beard and hair, wearing ornate armor with fur trim, stands in a dimly lit room. He is looking at a large, ornate mirror. In the mirror, a dragon with red eyes and sharp teeth is visible. The room has a round window with a cross pattern, and several lit candles are visible in the foreground and background.

Duality

Daniil Merkulov

Optimization for ML. Faculty of Computer Science. HSE University

Duality

Motivation

Duality lets us associate to any constrained optimization problem a concave maximization problem, whose solutions lower bound the optimal value of the original problem. What is interesting is that there are cases, when one can solve the primal problem by first solving the dual one. Now, consider a general constrained optimization problem:

Motivation

Duality lets us associate to any constrained optimization problem a concave maximization problem, whose solutions lower bound the optimal value of the original problem. What is interesting is that there are cases, when one can solve the primal problem by first solving the dual one. Now, consider a general constrained optimization problem:

$$\text{Primal: } f(x) \rightarrow \min_{x \in S} \qquad \text{Dual: } g(y) \rightarrow \max_{y \in \Omega}$$

Motivation

Duality lets us associate to any constrained optimization problem a concave maximization problem, whose solutions lower bound the optimal value of the original problem. What is interesting is that there are cases, when one can solve the primal problem by first solving the dual one. Now, consider a general constrained optimization problem:

$$\text{Primal: } f(x) \rightarrow \min_{x \in S} \quad \quad \text{Dual: } g(y) \rightarrow \max_{y \in \Omega}$$

We'll build $g(y)$, that preserves the uniform bound:

$$g(y) \leq f(x) \quad \forall x \in S, \forall y \in \Omega$$

Motivation

Duality lets us associate to any constrained optimization problem a concave maximization problem, whose solutions lower bound the optimal value of the original problem. What is interesting is that there are cases, when one can solve the primal problem by first solving the dual one. Now, consider a general constrained optimization problem:

$$\text{Primal: } f(x) \rightarrow \min_{x \in S} \quad \quad \text{Dual: } g(y) \rightarrow \max_{y \in \Omega}$$

We'll build $g(y)$, that preserves the uniform bound:

$$g(y) \leq f(x) \quad \forall x \in S, \forall y \in \Omega$$

As a consequence:

$$\max_{y \in \Omega} g(y) \leq \min_{x \in S} f(x)$$

Lagrange duality

We'll consider one of many possible ways to construct $g(y)$ in case, when we have a general mathematical programming problem with functional constraints:

Lagrange duality

We'll consider one of many possible ways to construct $g(y)$ in case, when we have a general mathematical programming problem with functional constraints:

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned}$$

Lagrange duality

We'll consider one of many possible ways to construct $g(y)$ in case, when we have a general mathematical programming problem with functional constraints:

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned}$$

And the Lagrangian, associated with this problem:

$$L(x, \lambda, \nu) = f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i f_i(x) + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i h_i(x) = f_0(x) + \lambda^\top f(x) + \nu^\top h(x)$$

Dual function

We assume $\mathcal{D} = \bigcap_{i=0}^m \text{dom } f_i \cap \bigcap_{i=1}^p \text{dom } h_i$ is nonempty. We define the Lagrange dual function (or just dual function) $g : \mathbb{R}^m \times \mathbb{R}^p \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ as the minimum value of the Lagrangian over x : for $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}^m, \nu \in \mathbb{R}^p$

Dual function

We assume $\mathcal{D} = \bigcap_{i=0}^m \text{dom } f_i \cap \bigcap_{i=1}^p \text{dom } h_i$ is nonempty. We define the Lagrange dual function (or just dual function) $g : \mathbb{R}^m \times \mathbb{R}^p \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ as the minimum value of the Lagrangian over x : for $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}^m, \nu \in \mathbb{R}^p$

$$g(\lambda, \nu) = \inf_{x \in \mathcal{D}} L(x, \lambda, \nu) = \inf_{x \in \mathcal{D}} \left(f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i f_i(x) + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i h_i(x) \right)$$

Dual function

We assume $\mathcal{D} = \bigcap_{i=0}^m \text{dom } f_i \cap \bigcap_{i=1}^p \text{dom } h_i$ is nonempty. We define the Lagrange dual function (or just dual function) $g : \mathbb{R}^m \times \mathbb{R}^p \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ as the minimum value of the Lagrangian over x : for $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}^m, \nu \in \mathbb{R}^p$

$$g(\lambda, \nu) = \inf_{x \in \mathcal{D}} L(x, \lambda, \nu) = \inf_{x \in \mathcal{D}} \left(f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i f_i(x) + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i h_i(x) \right)$$

When the Lagrangian is unbounded below in x , the dual function takes on the value $-\infty$. Since the dual function is the pointwise infimum of a family of affine functions of (λ, ν) , it is concave, even when the original problem is not convex.

Dual function as a lower bound

Let us show, that the dual function yields lower bounds on the optimal value p^* of the original problem for any $\lambda \succeq 0, \nu$. Suppose some $\hat{x}$ is a feasible point for the original problem, i.e., $f_i(\hat{x}) \leq 0$ and $h_i(\hat{x}) = 0, \lambda \succeq 0$. Then we have:

Dual function as a lower bound

Let us show, that the dual function yields lower bounds on the optimal value p^* of the original problem for any $\lambda \succeq 0, \nu$. Suppose some $\hat{x}$ is a feasible point for the original problem, i.e., $f_i(\hat{x}) \leq 0$ and $h_i(\hat{x}) = 0, \lambda \succeq 0$. Then we have:

$$L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) = f_0(\hat{x}) + \underbrace{\lambda^\top f(\hat{x})}_{\leq 0} + \underbrace{\nu^\top h(\hat{x})}_{=0} \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

Dual function as a lower bound

Let us show, that the dual function yields lower bounds on the optimal value p^* of the original problem for any $\lambda \succeq 0, \nu$. Suppose some $\hat{x}$ is a feasible point for the original problem, i.e., $f_i(\hat{x}) \leq 0$ and $h_i(\hat{x}) = 0, \lambda \succeq 0$. Then we have:

$$L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) = f_0(\hat{x}) + \underbrace{\lambda^\top f(\hat{x})}_{\leq 0} + \underbrace{\nu^\top h(\hat{x})}_{=0} \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

Hence

$$g(\lambda, \nu) = \inf_{x \in \mathcal{D}} L(x, \lambda, \nu) \leq L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

Dual function as a lower bound

Let us show, that the dual function yields lower bounds on the optimal value p^* of the original problem for any $\lambda \succeq 0, \nu$. Suppose some $\hat{x}$ is a feasible point for the original problem, i.e., $f_i(\hat{x}) \leq 0$ and $h_i(\hat{x}) = 0, \lambda \succeq 0$. Then we have:

$$L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) = f_0(\hat{x}) + \underbrace{\lambda^\top f(\hat{x})}_{\leq 0} + \underbrace{\nu^\top h(\hat{x})}_{=0} \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

Hence

$$g(\lambda, \nu) = \inf_{x \in \mathcal{D}} L(x, \lambda, \nu) \leq L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

$$g(\lambda, \nu) \leq p^*$$

Dual function as a lower bound

Let us show, that the dual function yields lower bounds on the optimal value p^* of the original problem for any $\lambda \succeq 0, \nu$. Suppose some $\hat{x}$ is a feasible point for the original problem, i.e., $f_i(\hat{x}) \leq 0$ and $h_i(\hat{x}) = 0, \lambda \succeq 0$. Then we have:

$$L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) = f_0(\hat{x}) + \underbrace{\lambda^\top f(\hat{x})}_{\leq 0} + \underbrace{\nu^\top h(\hat{x})}_{=0} \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

Hence

$$g(\lambda, \nu) = \inf_{x \in \mathcal{D}} L(x, \lambda, \nu) \leq L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

$$g(\lambda, \nu) \leq p^*$$

A natural question is: what is the *best* lower bound that can be obtained from the Lagrange dual function? This leads to the following optimization problem:

Dual function as a lower bound

Let us show, that the dual function yields lower bounds on the optimal value p^* of the original problem for any $\lambda \succeq 0, \nu$. Suppose some $\hat{x}$ is a feasible point for the original problem, i.e., $f_i(\hat{x}) \leq 0$ and $h_i(\hat{x}) = 0, \lambda \succeq 0$. Then we have:

$$L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) = f_0(\hat{x}) + \underbrace{\lambda^\top f(\hat{x})}_{\leq 0} + \underbrace{\nu^\top h(\hat{x})}_{=0} \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

Hence

$$g(\lambda, \nu) = \inf_{x \in \mathcal{D}} L(x, \lambda, \nu) \leq L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

$$g(\lambda, \nu) \leq p^*$$

A natural question is: what is the *best* lower bound that can be obtained from the Lagrange dual function? This leads to the following optimization problem:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\lambda, \nu) &\rightarrow \max_{\lambda \in \mathbb{R}^m, \nu \in \mathbb{R}^p} \\ \text{s.t. } &\lambda \succeq 0 \end{aligned}$$

Dual function as a lower bound

Let us show, that the dual function yields lower bounds on the optimal value p^* of the original problem for any $\lambda \succeq 0, \nu$. Suppose some $\hat{x}$ is a feasible point for the original problem, i.e., $f_i(\hat{x}) \leq 0$ and $h_i(\hat{x}) = 0$, $\lambda \succeq 0$. Then we have:

$$L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) = f_0(\hat{x}) + \underbrace{\lambda^\top f(\hat{x})}_{\leq 0} + \underbrace{\nu^\top h(\hat{x})}_{=0} \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

Hence

$$g(\lambda, \nu) = \inf_{x \in \mathcal{D}} L(x, \lambda, \nu) \leq L(\hat{x}, \lambda, \nu) \leq f_0(\hat{x})$$

$$g(\lambda, \nu) \leq p^*$$

A natural question is: what is the *best* lower bound that can be obtained from the Lagrange dual function? This leads to the following optimization problem:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\lambda, \nu) &\rightarrow \max_{\lambda \in \mathbb{R}^m, \nu \in \mathbb{R}^p} \\ \text{s.t. } &\lambda \succeq 0 \end{aligned}$$

The term “dual feasible”, to describe a pair (λ, ν) with $\lambda \succeq 0$ and $g(\lambda, \nu) > -\infty$, now makes sense. It means, as the name implies, that (λ, ν) is feasible for the dual problem. We refer to (λ^*, ν^*) as dual optimal or optimal Lagrange multipliers if they are optimal for the above problem.

Summary

	Primal	Dual
Function	$f_0(x)$	$g(\lambda, \nu) = \min_{x \in \mathcal{D}} L(x, \lambda, \nu)$
Variables	$x \in S \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$	$\lambda \in \mathbb{R}_+^m, \nu \in \mathbb{R}^p$
Constraints	$f_i(x) \leq 0, i = 1, \dots, m$ $h_i(x) = 0, i = 1, \dots, p$	$\lambda_i \geq 0, \forall i \in \overline{1, m}$
Problem	$\begin{aligned} & f_0(x) \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } & f_i(x) \leq 0, i = 1, \dots, m \\ & h_i(x) = 0, i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned}$	$\begin{aligned} & g(\lambda, \nu) \rightarrow \max_{\lambda \in \mathbb{R}^m, \nu \in \mathbb{R}^p} \\ \text{s.t. } & \lambda \succeq 0 \end{aligned}$
Optimal	x^* if feasible, $p^* = f_0(x^*)$	λ^*, ν^* if max is achieved, $d^* = g(\lambda^*, \nu^*)$

Example. Linear Least Squares

We are addressing a problem within a non-empty budget set, defined as follows:

Example. Linear Least Squares

We are addressing a problem within a non-empty budget set, defined as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ll}\min & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} & Ax = b,\end{array}$$

with the matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$.

Example. Linear Least Squares

We are addressing a problem within a non-empty budget set, defined as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ll}\min & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} & Ax = b,\end{array}$$

with the matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$.

This problem is devoid of inequality constraints, presenting m linear equality constraints instead. The Lagrangian is expressed as $L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$, spanning the domain $\mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R}^m$. The dual function is denoted by $g(\nu) = \inf_x L(x, \nu)$. Given that $L(x, \nu)$ manifests as a convex quadratic function in terms of x , the minimizing x can be derived from the optimality condition

Example. Linear Least Squares

We are addressing a problem within a non-empty budget set, defined as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ll}\min & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} & Ax = b,\end{array}$$

with the matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$.

This problem is devoid of inequality constraints, presenting m linear equality constraints instead. The Lagrangian is expressed as $L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$, spanning the domain $\mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R}^m$. The dual function is denoted by $g(\nu) = \inf_x L(x, \nu)$. Given that $L(x, \nu)$ manifests as a convex quadratic function in terms of x , the minimizing x can be derived from the optimality condition

$$\nabla_x L(x, \nu) = 2x + A^T \nu = 0,$$

Example. Linear Least Squares

We are addressing a problem within a non-empty budget set, defined as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ll}\min & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} & Ax = b,\end{array}$$

with the matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$.

This problem is devoid of inequality constraints, presenting m linear equality constraints instead. The Lagrangian is expressed as $L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$, spanning the domain $\mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R}^m$. The dual function is denoted by $g(\nu) = \inf_x L(x, \nu)$. Given that $L(x, \nu)$ manifests as a convex quadratic function in terms of x , the minimizing x can be derived from the optimality condition

$$\nabla_x L(x, \nu) = 2x + A^T \nu = 0,$$

leading to $x = -(1/2)A^T \nu$. As a result, the dual function is articulated as

Example. Linear Least Squares

We are addressing a problem within a non-empty budget set, defined as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ll}\min & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} & Ax = b,\end{array}$$

with the matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$.

This problem is devoid of inequality constraints, presenting m linear equality constraints instead. The Lagrangian is expressed as $L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$, spanning the domain $\mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R}^m$. The dual function is denoted by $g(\nu) = \inf_x L(x, \nu)$. Given that $L(x, \nu)$ manifests as a convex quadratic function in terms of x , the minimizing x can be derived from the optimality condition

$$\nabla_x L(x, \nu) = 2x + A^T \nu = 0,$$

leading to $x = -(1/2)A^T \nu$. As a result, the dual function is articulated as

$$g(\nu) = L(-(1/2)A^T \nu, \nu) = -(1/4)\nu^T A A^T \nu - b^T \nu,$$

Example. Linear Least Squares

We are addressing a problem within a non-empty budget set, defined as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ll}\min & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} & Ax = b,\end{array}$$

with the matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$.

This problem is devoid of inequality constraints, presenting m linear equality constraints instead. The Lagrangian is expressed as $L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$, spanning the domain $\mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R}^m$. The dual function is denoted by $g(\nu) = \inf_x L(x, \nu)$. Given that $L(x, \nu)$ manifests as a convex quadratic function in terms of x , the minimizing x can be derived from the optimality condition

$$\nabla_x L(x, \nu) = 2x + A^T \nu = 0,$$

leading to $x = -(1/2)A^T \nu$. As a result, the dual function is articulated as

emerging as a concave quadratic function within the domain $\mathbb{R}^p$. According to the lower bound property, for any $\nu \in \mathbb{R}^p$, the following holds true:

$$g(\nu) = L(-(1/2)A^T \nu, \nu) = -(1/4)\nu^T A A^T \nu - b^T \nu,$$

Example. Linear Least Squares

We are addressing a problem within a non-empty budget set, defined as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ll}\min & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} & Ax = b,\end{array}$$

with the matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$.

This problem is devoid of inequality constraints, presenting m linear equality constraints instead. The Lagrangian is expressed as $L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$, spanning the domain $\mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R}^m$. The dual function is denoted by $g(\nu) = \inf_x L(x, \nu)$. Given that $L(x, \nu)$ manifests as a convex quadratic function in terms of x , the minimizing x can be derived from the optimality condition

$$\nabla_x L(x, \nu) = 2x + A^T \nu = 0,$$

leading to $x = -(1/2)A^T \nu$. As a result, the dual function is articulated as

$$g(\nu) = L(-(1/2)A^T \nu, \nu) = -(1/4)\nu^T A A^T \nu - b^T \nu,$$

emerging as a concave quadratic function within the domain $\mathbb{R}^p$. According to the lower bound property, for any $\nu \in \mathbb{R}^p$, the following holds true:

$$-(1/4)\nu^T A A^T \nu - b^T \nu \leq \inf\{x^T x \mid Ax = b\}.$$

Which is a simple non-trivial lower bound without any problem solving.

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We are examining a (nonconvex) problem:

$$\text{minimize } x^T W x$$

$$\text{subject to } x_i^2 = 1, \quad i = 1, \dots, n,$$

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We are examining a (nonconvex) problem:

$$\text{minimize } x^T W x$$

$$\text{subject to } x_i^2 = 1, \quad i = 1, \dots, n,$$

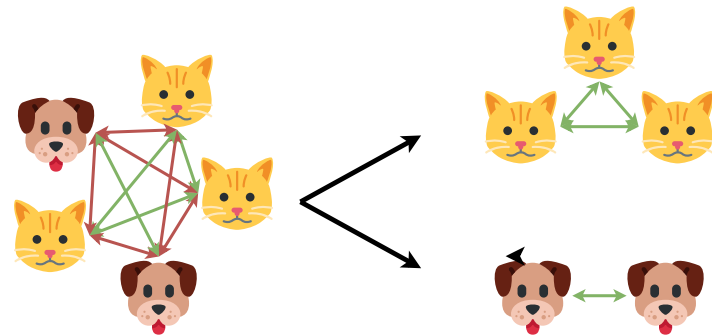


Figure 1: Illustration of two-way partitioning problem

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We are examining a (nonconvex) problem:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{minimize} && x^T W x \\ & \text{subject to} && x_i^2 = 1, \quad i = 1, \dots, n, \end{aligned}$$

This problem can be construed as a two-way partitioning problem over a set of n elements, denoted as $\{1, \dots, n\}$: A viable x corresponds to the partition

$$\{1, \dots, n\} = \{i | x_i = -1\} \cup \{i | x_i = 1\}.$$

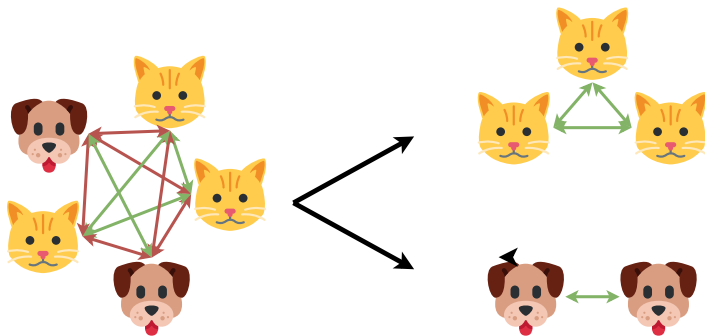


Figure 1: Illustration of two-way partitioning problem

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We are examining a (nonconvex) problem:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{minimize} && x^T W x \\ & \text{subject to} && x_i^2 = 1, \quad i = 1, \dots, n, \end{aligned}$$

This problem can be construed as a two-way partitioning problem over a set of n elements, denoted as $\{1, \dots, n\}$: A viable x corresponds to the partition

$$\{1, \dots, n\} = \{i | x_i = -1\} \cup \{i | x_i = 1\}.$$

The coefficient W_{ij} in the matrix represents the expense associated with placing elements i and j in the same partition, while $-W_{ij}$ signifies the cost of segregating them. The objective encapsulates the aggregate cost across all pairs of elements, and the challenge posed by problem is to find the partition that minimizes the total cost.

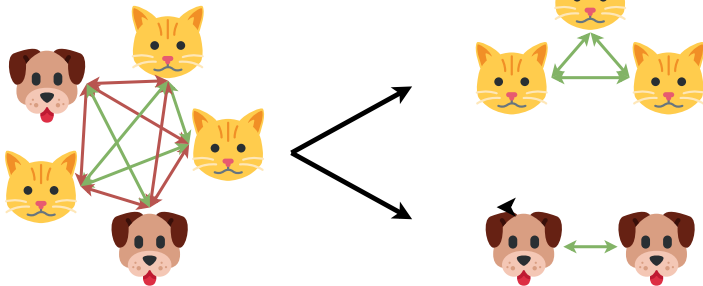


Figure 1: Illustration of two-way partitioning problem

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We now derive the dual function for this problem. The Lagrangian is expressed as

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T W x + \sum_{i=1}^n \nu_i (x_i^2 - 1) = x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu.$$

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We now derive the dual function for this problem. The Lagrangian is expressed as

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T W x + \sum_{i=1}^n \nu_i (x_i^2 - 1) = x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu.$$

By minimizing over x , we procure the Lagrange dual function:

$$g(\nu) = \inf_x x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu = \begin{cases} -\mathbf{1}^T \nu & \text{if } W + \text{diag}(\nu) \succeq 0 \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We now derive the dual function for this problem. The Lagrangian is expressed as

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T W x + \sum_{i=1}^n \nu_i (x_i^2 - 1) = x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu.$$

By minimizing over x , we procure the Lagrange dual function:

$$g(\nu) = \inf_x x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu = \begin{cases} -\mathbf{1}^T \nu & \text{if } W + \text{diag}(\nu) \succeq 0 \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

exploiting the realization that the infimum of a quadratic form is either zero (when the form is positive semidefinite) or $-\infty$ (when it's not).

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We now derive the dual function for this problem. The Lagrangian is expressed as

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T W x + \sum_{i=1}^n \nu_i (x_i^2 - 1) = x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu.$$

By minimizing over x , we procure the Lagrange dual function:

$$g(\nu) = \inf_x x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu = \begin{cases} -\mathbf{1}^T \nu & \text{if } W + \text{diag}(\nu) \succeq 0 \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

exploiting the realization that the infimum of a quadratic form is either zero (when the form is positive semidefinite) or $-\infty$ (when it's not).

This dual function furnishes lower bounds on the optimal value of the problem. For instance, we can adopt the particular value of the dual variable

$$\nu = -\lambda_{\min}(W) \mathbf{1}$$

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We now derive the dual function for this problem. The Lagrangian is expressed as

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T W x + \sum_{i=1}^n \nu_i (x_i^2 - 1) = x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu.$$

By minimizing over x , we procure the Lagrange dual function:

$$g(\nu) = \inf_x x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu = \begin{cases} -\mathbf{1}^T \nu & \text{if } W + \text{diag}(\nu) \succeq 0 \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

exploiting the realization that the infimum of a quadratic form is either zero (when the form is positive semidefinite) or $-\infty$ (when it's not).

This dual function furnishes lower bounds on the optimal value of the problem. For instance, we can adopt the particular value of the dual variable

$$\nu = -\lambda_{\min}(W) \mathbf{1}$$

which is dual feasible, since $W + \text{diag}(\nu) = W - \lambda_{\min}(W) I \succeq 0$.

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We now derive the dual function for this problem. The Lagrangian is expressed as

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T W x + \sum_{i=1}^n \nu_i (x_i^2 - 1) = x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu.$$

By minimizing over x , we procure the Lagrange dual function:

$$g(\nu) = \inf_x x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu = \begin{cases} -\mathbf{1}^T \nu & \text{if } W + \text{diag}(\nu) \succeq 0 \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

exploiting the realization that the infimum of a quadratic form is either zero (when the form is positive semidefinite) or $-\infty$ (when it's not).

This dual function furnishes lower bounds on the optimal value of the problem. For instance, we can adopt the particular value of the dual variable

$$\nu = -\lambda_{\min}(W) \mathbf{1}$$

which is dual feasible, since $W + \text{diag}(\nu) = W - \lambda_{\min}(W) I \succeq 0$.

This renders a simple bound on the optimal value p^* : $p^* \geq -\mathbf{1}^T \nu = n \lambda_{\min}(W)$.

Example. Two-way partitioning problem

We now derive the dual function for this problem. The Lagrangian is expressed as

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T W x + \sum_{i=1}^n \nu_i (x_i^2 - 1) = x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu.$$

By minimizing over x , we procure the Lagrange dual function:

$$g(\nu) = \inf_x x^T (W + \text{diag}(\nu)) x - \mathbf{1}^T \nu = \begin{cases} -\mathbf{1}^T \nu & \text{if } W + \text{diag}(\nu) \succeq 0 \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

exploiting the realization that the infimum of a quadratic form is either zero (when the form is positive semidefinite) or $-\infty$ (when it's not).

This dual function furnishes lower bounds on the optimal value of the problem. For instance, we can adopt the particular value of the dual variable

$$\nu = -\lambda_{\min}(W) \mathbf{1}$$

which is dual feasible, since $W + \text{diag}(\nu) = W - \lambda_{\min}(W) I \succeq 0$.

This renders a simple bound on the optimal value p^* : $p^* \geq -\mathbf{1}^T \nu = n \lambda_{\min}(W)$.

The code for the problem is available here  Open in Colab

Strong duality

Strong duality

It is common to name this relation between optimals of primal and dual problems as **weak duality**. For problem, we have:

$$p^* \geq d^*$$

Strong duality

It is common to name this relation between optimals of primal and dual problems as **weak duality**. For problem, we have:

$$p^* \geq d^*$$

While the difference between them is often called **duality gap**:

$$p^* - d^* \geq 0$$

Strong duality

It is common to name this relation between optimals of primal and dual problems as **weak duality**. For problem, we have:

$$p^* \geq d^*$$

While the difference between them is often called **duality gap**:

$$p^* - d^* \geq 0$$

Note, that we always have weak duality, if we've formulated primal and dual problem. It means, that if we have managed to solve the dual problem (which is always concave, no matter whether the initial problem was or not), then we have some lower bound. Surprisingly, there are some notable cases, when these solutions are equal.

Strong duality

It is common to name this relation between optimals of primal and dual problems as **weak duality**. For problem, we have:

$$p^* \geq d^*$$

While the difference between them is often called **duality gap**:

$$p^* - d^* \geq 0$$

Note, that we always have weak duality, if we've formulated primal and dual problem. It means, that if we have managed to solve the dual problem (which is always concave, no matter whether the initial problem was or not), then we have some lower bound. Surprisingly, there are some notable cases, when these solutions are equal.

Strong duality happens if duality gap is zero:

$$p^* = d^*$$

Strong duality

It is common to name this relation between optimals of primal and dual problems as **weak duality**. For problem, we have:

$$p^* \geq d^*$$

While the difference between them is often called **duality gap**:

$$p^* - d^* \geq 0$$

Note, that we always have weak duality, if we've formulated primal and dual problem. It means, that if we have managed to solve the dual problem (which is always concave, no matter whether the initial problem was or not), then we have some lower bound. Surprisingly, there are some notable cases, when these solutions are equal.

Strong duality happens if duality gap is zero:

$$p^* = d^*$$

Notice: both p^* and d^* may be ∞ .

- Several sufficient conditions known!

Strong duality

It is common to name this relation between optimals of primal and dual problems as **weak duality**. For problem, we have:

$$p^* \geq d^*$$

While the difference between them is often called **duality gap**:

$$p^* - d^* \geq 0$$

Note, that we always have weak duality, if we've formulated primal and dual problem. It means, that if we have managed to solve the dual problem (which is always concave, no matter whether the initial problem was or not), then we have some lower bound. Surprisingly, there are some notable cases, when these solutions are equal.

Strong duality happens if duality gap is zero:

$$p^* = d^*$$

Notice: both p^* and d^* may be ∞ .

- Several sufficient conditions known!
- “Easy” necessary and sufficient conditions: unknown.

Strong duality in linear least squares

Exercise

In the Least-squares solution of linear equations example above calculate the primal optimum p^* and the dual optimum d^* and check whether this problem has strong duality or not.

Strong duality in linear least squares

Exercise

In the Least-squares solution of linear equations example above calculate the primal optimum p^* and the dual optimum d^* and check whether this problem has strong duality or not.

Primal problem:

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & Ax = b, \end{aligned}$$

Dual problem:

$$\max_{\nu \in \mathbb{R}^m} -\frac{1}{4} \nu^T A A^T \nu - b^T \nu$$

1. Lagrangian:

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$$

Strong duality in linear least squares

i Exercise

In the Least-squares solution of linear equations example above calculate the primal optimum p^* and the dual optimum d^* and check whether this problem has strong duality or not.

Primal problem:

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & Ax = b, \end{aligned}$$

Dual problem:

$$\max_{\nu \in \mathbb{R}^m} -\frac{1}{4} \nu^T A A^T \nu - b^T \nu$$

1. Lagrangian:

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$$

2. KKT conditions:

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla_x L(x, \nu) &= 2x + A^T \nu = 0 \\ Ax - b &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

Strong duality in linear least squares

i Exercise

In the Least-squares solution of linear equations example above calculate the primal optimum p^* and the dual optimum d^* and check whether this problem has strong duality or not.

Primal problem:

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & Ax = b, \end{aligned}$$

Dual problem:

$$\max_{\nu \in \mathbb{R}^m} -\frac{1}{4} \nu^T A A^T \nu - b^T \nu$$

1. Lagrangian:

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$$

2. KKT conditions:

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla_x L(x, \nu) &= 2x + A^T \nu = 0 \\ Ax - b &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

$$3. \quad x^* = A^T (A A^T)^{-1} b \quad p^* = b^T (A A^T)^{-1} b.$$

Strong duality in linear least squares

Exercise

In the Least-squares solution of linear equations example above calculate the primal optimum p^* and the dual optimum d^* and check whether this problem has strong duality or not.

Primal problem:

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & Ax = b, \end{aligned}$$

1. Lagrangian:

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$$

2. KKT conditions:

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla_x L(x, \nu) &= 2x + A^T \nu = 0 \\ Ax - b &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

$$3. \quad x^* = A^T (AA^T)^{-1} b \quad p^* = b^T (AA^T)^{-1} b.$$

Dual problem:

$$\max_{\nu \in \mathbb{R}^m} -\frac{1}{4} \nu^T AA^T \nu - b^T \nu$$

1. KKT:

$$-\frac{1}{2} AA^T \nu - b = 0$$

Strong duality in linear least squares

i Exercise

In the Least-squares solution of linear equations example above calculate the primal optimum p^* and the dual optimum d^* and check whether this problem has strong duality or not.

Primal problem:

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad & x^T x \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & Ax = b, \end{aligned}$$

1. Lagrangian:

$$L(x, \nu) = x^T x + \nu^T (Ax - b)$$

2. KKT conditions:

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla_x L(x, \nu) &= 2x + A^T \nu = 0 \\ Ax - b &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

$$3. \quad x^* = A^T (AA^T)^{-1} b \quad p^* = b^T (AA^T)^{-1} b.$$

Dual problem:

$$\max_{\nu \in \mathbb{R}^m} -\frac{1}{4} \nu^T AA^T \nu - b^T \nu$$

1. KKT:

$$-\frac{1}{2} AA^T \nu - b = 0$$

$$2. \quad \nu^* = -2(AA^T)^{-1} b \quad d^* = b^T (AA^T)^{-1} b.$$

Slater's condition

Theorem

If for a convex optimization problem (i.e., assuming minimization, f_0, f_i are convex and h_i are affine), there exists a point x such that $h(x) = 0$ and $f_i(x) < 0$ (existence of a strictly feasible point), then we have a zero duality gap and KKT conditions become necessary and sufficient.

An example of convex problem, when Slater's condition does not hold

i Example

$$\min\{f_0(x) = x \mid f_1(x) = \frac{x^2}{2} \leq 0\},$$

An example of convex problem, when Slater's condition does not hold

Example

$$\min\{f_0(x) = x \mid f_1(x) = \frac{x^2}{2} \leq 0\},$$

The only point in the budget set is: $x^* = 0$. However, it is impossible to find a non-negative $\lambda^* \geq 0$, such that

$$\nabla f_0(0) + \lambda^* \nabla f_1(0) = 1 + \lambda^* x = 0.$$

Useful features of duality

- **Construction of lower bound on solution of the primal problem.**

It could be very complicated to solve the initial problem. But if we have the dual problem, we can take an arbitrary $y \in \Omega$ and substitute it in $g(y)$ - we'll immediately obtain some lower bound.

Useful features of duality

- **Construction of lower bound on solution of the primal problem.**

It could be very complicated to solve the initial problem. But if we have the dual problem, we can take an arbitrary $y \in \Omega$ and substitute it in $g(y)$ - we'll immediately obtain some lower bound.

- **Checking for the problem's solvability and attainability of the solution.**

From the inequality $\max_{y \in \Omega} g(y) \leq \min_{x \in S} f_0(x)$ follows: if $\min_{x \in S} f_0(x) = -\infty$, then $\Omega = \emptyset$ and vice versa.

Useful features of duality

- **Construction of lower bound on solution of the primal problem.**

It could be very complicated to solve the initial problem. But if we have the dual problem, we can take an arbitrary $y \in \Omega$ and substitute it in $g(y)$ - we'll immediately obtain some lower bound.

- **Checking for the problem's solvability and attainability of the solution.**

From the inequality $\max_{y \in \Omega} g(y) \leq \min_{x \in S} f_0(x)$ follows: if $\min_{x \in S} f_0(x) = -\infty$, then $\Omega = \emptyset$ and vice versa.

- **Sometimes it is easier to solve a dual problem than a primal one.**

In this case, if the strong duality holds: $g(y^*) = f_0(x^*)$ we lose nothing.

Useful features of duality

- **Construction of lower bound on solution of the primal problem.**

It could be very complicated to solve the initial problem. But if we have the dual problem, we can take an arbitrary $y \in \Omega$ and substitute it in $g(y)$ - we'll immediately obtain some lower bound.

- **Checking for the problem's solvability and attainability of the solution.**

From the inequality $\max_{y \in \Omega} g(y) \leq \min_{x \in S} f_0(x)$ follows: if $\min_{x \in S} f_0(x) = -\infty$, then $\Omega = \emptyset$ and vice versa.

- **Sometimes it is easier to solve a dual problem than a primal one.**

In this case, if the strong duality holds: $g(y^*) = f_0(x^*)$ we lose nothing.

- **Obtaining a lower bound on the function's residual.**

$f_0(x) - f_0^* \leq f_0(x) - g(y)$ for an arbitrary $y \in \Omega$ (suboptimality certificate). Moreover, $p^* \in [g(y), f_0(x)]$, $d^* \in [g(y), f_0(x)]$

Useful features of duality

- **Construction of lower bound on solution of the primal problem.**

It could be very complicated to solve the initial problem. But if we have the dual problem, we can take an arbitrary $y \in \Omega$ and substitute it in $g(y)$ - we'll immediately obtain some lower bound.

- **Checking for the problem's solvability and attainability of the solution.**

From the inequality $\max_{y \in \Omega} g(y) \leq \min_{x \in S} f_0(x)$ follows: if $\min_{x \in S} f_0(x) = -\infty$, then $\Omega = \emptyset$ and vice versa.

- **Sometimes it is easier to solve a dual problem than a primal one.**

In this case, if the strong duality holds: $g(y^*) = f_0(x^*)$ we lose nothing.

- **Obtaining a lower bound on the function's residual.**

$f_0(x) - f_0^* \leq f_0(x) - g(y)$ for an arbitrary $y \in \Omega$ (suboptimality certificate). Moreover, $p^* \in [g(y), f_0(x)]$, $d^* \in [g(y), f_0(x)]$

- **Dual function is always concave**

As a pointwise minimum of affine functions.

Sensitivity analysis

Sensitivity analysis

Let us switch from the original optimization problem

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{P})$$

Sensitivity analysis

Let us switch from the original optimization problem

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{P})$$

To the perturbed version of it:

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq u_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= v_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{Per})$$

Sensitivity analysis

Let us switch from the original optimization problem

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{P})$$

To the perturbed version of it:

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq u_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= v_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{Per})$$

Note, that we still have the only variable $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$, while treating $u \in \mathbb{R}^m, v \in \mathbb{R}^p$ as parameters. It is obvious, that $\text{Per}(u, v) \rightarrow \text{P}$ if $u = 0, v = 0$. We will denote the optimal value of Per as $p^*(u, v)$, while the optimal value of the original problem P is just p^* . One can immediately say, that $p^*(u, v) = p^*$.

Sensitivity analysis

Let us switch from the original optimization problem

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{P})$$

To the perturbed version of it:

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq u_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= v_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{Per})$$

Note, that we still have the only variable $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$, while treating $u \in \mathbb{R}^m, v \in \mathbb{R}^p$ as parameters. It is obvious, that $\text{Per}(u, v) \rightarrow \text{P}$ if $u = 0, v = 0$. We will denote the optimal value of Per as $p^*(u, v)$, while the optimal value of the original problem P is just p^* . One can immediately say, that $p^*(u, v) = p^*$.

Speaking of the value of some i -th constraint we can say, that

- $u_i = 0$ leaves the original problem

Sensitivity analysis

Let us switch from the original optimization problem

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{P})$$

To the perturbed version of it:

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq u_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= v_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{Per})$$

Note, that we still have the only variable $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$, while treating $u \in \mathbb{R}^m, v \in \mathbb{R}^p$ as parameters. It is obvious, that $\text{Per}(u, v) \rightarrow \text{P}$ if $u = 0, v = 0$. We will denote the optimal value of Per as $p^*(u, v)$, while the optimal value of the original problem P is just p^* . One can immediately say, that $p^*(u, v) = p^*$.

Speaking of the value of some i -th constraint we can say, that

- $u_i = 0$ leaves the original problem
- $u_i > 0$ means that we have relaxed the inequality

Sensitivity analysis

Let us switch from the original optimization problem

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{P})$$

To the perturbed version of it:

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq u_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= v_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{Per})$$

Note, that we still have the only variable $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$, while treating $u \in \mathbb{R}^m, v \in \mathbb{R}^p$ as parameters. It is obvious, that $\text{Per}(u, v) \rightarrow \text{P}$ if $u = 0, v = 0$. We will denote the optimal value of Per as $p^*(u, v)$, while the optimal value of the original problem P is just p^* . One can immediately say, that $p^*(u, v) = p^*$.

Speaking of the value of some i -th constraint we can say, that

- $u_i = 0$ leaves the original problem
- $u_i > 0$ means that we have relaxed the inequality
- $u_i < 0$ means that we have tightened the constraint

Sensitivity analysis

Let us switch from the original optimization problem

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{P})$$

To the perturbed version of it:

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq u_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= v_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{Per})$$

Note, that we still have the only variable $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$, while treating $u \in \mathbb{R}^m, v \in \mathbb{R}^p$ as parameters. It is obvious, that $\text{Per}(u, v) \rightarrow \text{P}$ if $u = 0, v = 0$. We will denote the optimal value of Per as $p^*(u, v)$, while the optimal value of the original problem P is just p^* . One can immediately say, that $p^*(u, v) = p^*$.

Speaking of the value of some i -th constraint we can say, that

- $u_i = 0$ leaves the original problem
- $u_i > 0$ means that we have relaxed the inequality
- $u_i < 0$ means that we have tightened the constraint

Sensitivity analysis

Let us switch from the original optimization problem

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= 0, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{P})$$

To the perturbed version of it:

$$\begin{aligned} f_0(x) &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } f_i(x) &\leq u_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, m \\ h_i(x) &= v_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, p \end{aligned} \quad (\text{Per})$$

Note, that we still have the only variable $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$, while treating $u \in \mathbb{R}^m, v \in \mathbb{R}^p$ as parameters. It is obvious, that $\text{Per}(u, v) \rightarrow \text{P}$ if $u = 0, v = 0$. We will denote the optimal value of Per as $p^*(u, v)$, while the optimal value of the original problem P is just p^* . One can immediately say, that $p^*(u, v) = p^*$.

Speaking of the value of some i -th constraint we can say, that

- $u_i = 0$ leaves the original problem
- $u_i > 0$ means that we have relaxed the inequality
- $u_i < 0$ means that we have tightened the constraint

One can even show, that when P is convex optimization problem, $p^*(u, v)$ is a convex function.

Sensitivity analysis

Suppose, that strong duality holds for the original problem and suppose, that x is any feasible point for the perturbed problem:

$$p^*(0, 0) = p^* = d^* = g(\lambda^*, \nu^*) \leq$$

Sensitivity analysis

Suppose, that strong duality holds for the original problem and suppose, that x is any feasible point for the perturbed problem:

$$\begin{aligned} p^*(0,0) = p^* = d^* = g(\lambda^*, \nu^*) &\leq \\ &\leq L(x, \lambda^*, \nu^*) = \end{aligned}$$

Sensitivity analysis

Suppose, that strong duality holds for the original problem and suppose, that x is any feasible point for the perturbed problem:

$$\begin{aligned} p^*(0,0) &= p^* = d^* = g(\lambda^*, \nu^*) \leq \\ &\leq L(x, \lambda^*, \nu^*) = \\ &= f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i^* f_i(x) + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i^* h_i(x) \leq \end{aligned}$$

Sensitivity analysis

Suppose, that strong duality holds for the original problem and suppose, that x is any feasible point for the perturbed problem:

$$\begin{aligned} p^*(0,0) &= p^* = d^* = g(\lambda^*, \nu^*) \leq \\ &\leq L(x, \lambda^*, \nu^*) = \\ &= f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i^* f_i(x) + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i^* h_i(x) \leq \\ &\leq f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i^* u_i + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i^* v_i \end{aligned}$$

Sensitivity analysis

Suppose, that strong duality holds for the original problem and suppose, that x is any feasible point for the perturbed problem:

$$\begin{aligned} p^*(0,0) &= p^* = d^* = g(\lambda^*, \nu^*) \leq \\ &\leq L(x, \lambda^*, \nu^*) = \\ &= f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i^* f_i(x) + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i^* h_i(x) \leq \\ &\leq f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i^* u_i + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i^* v_i \end{aligned}$$

Sensitivity analysis

Suppose, that strong duality holds for the original problem and suppose, that x is any feasible point for the perturbed problem:

$$\begin{aligned} p^*(0,0) &= p^* = d^* = g(\lambda^*, \nu^*) \leq \\ &\leq L(x, \lambda^*, \nu^*) = \\ &= f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i^* f_i(x) + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i^* h_i(x) \leq \\ &\leq f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i^* u_i + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i^* v_i \end{aligned}$$

Which means

$$f_0(x) \geq p^*(0,0) - \lambda^{*T} u - \nu^{*T} v$$

Sensitivity analysis

Suppose, that strong duality holds for the original problem and suppose, that x is any feasible point for the perturbed problem:

$$\begin{aligned} p^*(0,0) &= p^* = d^* = g(\lambda^*, \nu^*) \leq \\ &\leq L(x, \lambda^*, \nu^*) = \\ &= f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i^* f_i(x) + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i^* h_i(x) \leq \\ &\leq f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i^* u_i + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i^* v_i \end{aligned}$$

Which means

$$f_0(x) \geq p^*(0,0) - \lambda^{*T} u - \nu^{*T} v$$

And taking the optimal x for the perturbed problem, we have:

$$p^*(u, v) \geq p^*(0,0) - \lambda^{*T} u - \nu^{*T} v \quad (1)$$

Sensitivity analysis

In scenarios where strong duality holds, we can draw several insights about the sensitivity of optimal solutions in relation to the Lagrange multipliers. These insights are derived from the inequality expressed in equation above:

- **Impact of Tightening a Constraint (Large λ_i^*):**

When the i th constraint's Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , holds a substantial value, and if this constraint is tightened (choosing $u_i < 0$), there is a guarantee that the optimal value, denoted by $p^*(u, v)$, will significantly increase.

Sensitivity analysis

In scenarios where strong duality holds, we can draw several insights about the sensitivity of optimal solutions in relation to the Lagrange multipliers. These insights are derived from the inequality expressed in equation above:

- **Impact of Tightening a Constraint (Large λ_i^*):**

When the i th constraint's Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , holds a substantial value, and if this constraint is tightened (choosing $u_i < 0$), there is a guarantee that the optimal value, denoted by $p^*(u, v)$, will significantly increase.

- **Effect of Adjusting Constraints with Large Positive or Negative ν_i^* :**

Sensitivity analysis

In scenarios where strong duality holds, we can draw several insights about the sensitivity of optimal solutions in relation to the Lagrange multipliers. These insights are derived from the inequality expressed in equation above:

- **Impact of Tightening a Constraint (Large λ_i^*):**

When the i th constraint's Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , holds a substantial value, and if this constraint is tightened (choosing $u_i < 0$), there is a guarantee that the optimal value, denoted by $p^*(u, v)$, will significantly increase.

- **Effect of Adjusting Constraints with Large Positive or Negative ν_i^* :**

- If ν_i^* is large and positive and $v_i < 0$ is chosen, or

Sensitivity analysis

In scenarios where strong duality holds, we can draw several insights about the sensitivity of optimal solutions in relation to the Lagrange multipliers. These insights are derived from the inequality expressed in equation above:

- **Impact of Tightening a Constraint (Large λ_i^*):**

When the i th constraint's Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , holds a substantial value, and if this constraint is tightened (choosing $u_i < 0$), there is a guarantee that the optimal value, denoted by $p^*(u, v)$, will significantly increase.

- **Effect of Adjusting Constraints with Large Positive or Negative ν_i^* :**

- If ν_i^* is large and positive and $v_i < 0$ is chosen, or
- If ν_i^* is large and negative and $v_i > 0$ is selected, then in either scenario, the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ is expected to increase greatly.

Sensitivity analysis

In scenarios where strong duality holds, we can draw several insights about the sensitivity of optimal solutions in relation to the Lagrange multipliers. These insights are derived from the inequality expressed in equation above:

- **Impact of Tightening a Constraint (Large λ_i^*):**

When the i th constraint's Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , holds a substantial value, and if this constraint is tightened (choosing $u_i < 0$), there is a guarantee that the optimal value, denoted by $p^*(u, v)$, will significantly increase.

- **Effect of Adjusting Constraints with Large Positive or Negative ν_i^* :**

- If ν_i^* is large and positive and $v_i < 0$ is chosen, or
- If ν_i^* is large and negative and $v_i > 0$ is selected, then in either scenario, the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ is expected to increase greatly.

- **Consequences of Loosening a Constraint (Small λ_i^*):**

If the Lagrange multiplier λ_i^* for the i th constraint is relatively small, and the constraint is loosened (choosing $u_i > 0$), it is anticipated that the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ will not significantly decrease.

Sensitivity analysis

In scenarios where strong duality holds, we can draw several insights about the sensitivity of optimal solutions in relation to the Lagrange multipliers. These insights are derived from the inequality expressed in equation above:

- **Impact of Tightening a Constraint (Large λ_i^*):**

When the i th constraint's Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , holds a substantial value, and if this constraint is tightened (choosing $u_i < 0$), there is a guarantee that the optimal value, denoted by $p^*(u, v)$, will significantly increase.

- **Effect of Adjusting Constraints with Large Positive or Negative ν_i^* :**

- If ν_i^* is large and positive and $v_i < 0$ is chosen, or
- If ν_i^* is large and negative and $v_i > 0$ is selected, then in either scenario, the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ is expected to increase greatly.

- **Consequences of Loosening a Constraint (Small λ_i^*):**

If the Lagrange multiplier λ_i^* for the i th constraint is relatively small, and the constraint is loosened (choosing $u_i > 0$), it is anticipated that the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ will not significantly decrease.

- **Outcomes of Tiny Adjustments in Constraints with Small ν_i^* :**

Sensitivity analysis

In scenarios where strong duality holds, we can draw several insights about the sensitivity of optimal solutions in relation to the Lagrange multipliers. These insights are derived from the inequality expressed in equation above:

- **Impact of Tightening a Constraint (Large λ_i^*):**

When the i th constraint's Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , holds a substantial value, and if this constraint is tightened (choosing $u_i < 0$), there is a guarantee that the optimal value, denoted by $p^*(u, v)$, will significantly increase.

- **Effect of Adjusting Constraints with Large Positive or Negative ν_i^* :**

- If ν_i^* is large and positive and $v_i < 0$ is chosen, or
- If ν_i^* is large and negative and $v_i > 0$ is selected, then in either scenario, the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ is expected to increase greatly.

- **Consequences of Loosening a Constraint (Small λ_i^*):**

If the Lagrange multiplier λ_i^* for the i th constraint is relatively small, and the constraint is loosened (choosing $u_i > 0$), it is anticipated that the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ will not significantly decrease.

- **Outcomes of Tiny Adjustments in Constraints with Small ν_i^* :**

- When ν_i^* is small and positive, and $v_i > 0$ is chosen, or

Sensitivity analysis

In scenarios where strong duality holds, we can draw several insights about the sensitivity of optimal solutions in relation to the Lagrange multipliers. These insights are derived from the inequality expressed in equation above:

- **Impact of Tightening a Constraint (Large λ_i^*):**

When the i th constraint's Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , holds a substantial value, and if this constraint is tightened (choosing $u_i < 0$), there is a guarantee that the optimal value, denoted by $p^*(u, v)$, will significantly increase.

- **Effect of Adjusting Constraints with Large Positive or Negative ν_i^* :**

- If ν_i^* is large and positive and $v_i < 0$ is chosen, or
- If ν_i^* is large and negative and $v_i > 0$ is selected, then in either scenario, the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ is expected to increase greatly.

- **Consequences of Loosening a Constraint (Small λ_i^*):**

If the Lagrange multiplier λ_i^* for the i th constraint is relatively small, and the constraint is loosened (choosing $u_i > 0$), it is anticipated that the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ will not significantly decrease.

- **Outcomes of Tiny Adjustments in Constraints with Small ν_i^* :**

- When ν_i^* is small and positive, and $v_i > 0$ is chosen, or
- When ν_i^* is small and negative, and $v_i < 0$ is opted for, in both cases, the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ will not significantly decrease.

Sensitivity analysis

In scenarios where strong duality holds, we can draw several insights about the sensitivity of optimal solutions in relation to the Lagrange multipliers. These insights are derived from the inequality expressed in equation above:

- **Impact of Tightening a Constraint (Large λ_i^*):**

When the i th constraint's Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , holds a substantial value, and if this constraint is tightened (choosing $u_i < 0$), there is a guarantee that the optimal value, denoted by $p^*(u, v)$, will significantly increase.

- **Effect of Adjusting Constraints with Large Positive or Negative ν_i^* :**

- If ν_i^* is large and positive and $v_i < 0$ is chosen, or
- If ν_i^* is large and negative and $v_i > 0$ is selected, then in either scenario, the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ is expected to increase greatly.

- **Consequences of Loosening a Constraint (Small λ_i^*):**

If the Lagrange multiplier λ_i^* for the i th constraint is relatively small, and the constraint is loosened (choosing $u_i > 0$), it is anticipated that the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ will not significantly decrease.

- **Outcomes of Tiny Adjustments in Constraints with Small ν_i^* :**

- When ν_i^* is small and positive, and $v_i > 0$ is chosen, or
- When ν_i^* is small and negative, and $v_i < 0$ is opted for, in both cases, the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ will not significantly decrease.

Sensitivity analysis

In scenarios where strong duality holds, we can draw several insights about the sensitivity of optimal solutions in relation to the Lagrange multipliers. These insights are derived from the inequality expressed in equation above:

- **Impact of Tightening a Constraint (Large λ_i^*):**

When the i th constraint's Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , holds a substantial value, and if this constraint is tightened (choosing $u_i < 0$), there is a guarantee that the optimal value, denoted by $p^*(u, v)$, will significantly increase.

- **Effect of Adjusting Constraints with Large Positive or Negative ν_i^* :**

- If ν_i^* is large and positive and $v_i < 0$ is chosen, or
- If ν_i^* is large and negative and $v_i > 0$ is selected, then in either scenario, the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ is expected to increase greatly.

- **Consequences of Loosening a Constraint (Small λ_i^*):**

If the Lagrange multiplier λ_i^* for the i th constraint is relatively small, and the constraint is loosened (choosing $u_i > 0$), it is anticipated that the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ will not significantly decrease.

- **Outcomes of Tiny Adjustments in Constraints with Small ν_i^* :**

- When ν_i^* is small and positive, and $v_i > 0$ is chosen, or
- When ν_i^* is small and negative, and $v_i < 0$ is opted for, in both cases, the optimal value $p^*(u, v)$ will not significantly decrease.

These interpretations provide a framework for understanding how changes in constraints, reflected through their corresponding Lagrange multipliers, impact the optimal solution in problems where strong duality holds.

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

$$\lambda_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \quad \nu_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial v_i} \quad (2)$$

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

$$\lambda_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \quad \nu_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial v_i} \quad (2)$$

To show this result we consider the directional derivative of $p^*(u, v)$ along the direction of some i -th basis vector e_i :

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

$$\lambda_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \quad \nu_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial v_i} \quad (2)$$

To show this result we consider the directional derivative of $p^*(u, v)$ along the direction of some i -th basis vector e_i :

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*(0, 0)}{t} = \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i}$$

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

$$\lambda_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \quad \nu_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial v_i} \quad (2)$$

To show this result we consider the directional derivative of $p^*(u, v)$ along the direction of some i -th basis vector e_i :

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*(0, 0)}{t} = \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i}$$

From the inequality Equation 1 and taking the limit $t \rightarrow 0$ with $t > 0$ we have

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

$$\lambda_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \quad \nu_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial v_i} \quad (2)$$

To show this result we consider the directional derivative of $p^*(u, v)$ along the direction of some i -th basis vector e_i :

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*(0, 0)}{t} = \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i}$$

From the inequality Equation 1 and taking the limit $t \rightarrow 0$ with $t > 0$ we have

$$\frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*}{t} \geq -\lambda_i^* \rightarrow \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \geq -\lambda_i^*$$

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

$$\lambda_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \quad \nu_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial v_i} \quad (2)$$

To show this result we consider the directional derivative of $p^*(u, v)$ along the direction of some i -th basis vector e_i :

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*(0, 0)}{t} = \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i}$$

From the inequality Equation 1 and taking the limit $t \rightarrow 0$ with $t > 0$ we have

$$\frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*}{t} \geq -\lambda_i^* \rightarrow \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \geq -\lambda_i^*$$

For the negative $t < 0$ we have:

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

$$\lambda_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \quad \nu_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial v_i} \quad (2)$$

To show this result we consider the directional derivative of $p^*(u, v)$ along the direction of some i -th basis vector e_i :

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*(0, 0)}{t} = \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i}$$

From the inequality Equation 1 and taking the limit $t \rightarrow 0$ with $t > 0$ we have

$$\frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*}{t} \geq -\lambda_i^* \rightarrow \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \geq -\lambda_i^*$$

For the negative $t < 0$ we have:

$$\frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*}{t} \leq -\lambda_i^* \rightarrow \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \leq -\lambda_i^*$$

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

The same idea can be used to establish the fact about v_i .

$$\lambda_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \quad \nu_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial v_i} \quad (2)$$

To show this result we consider the directional derivative of $p^*(u, v)$ along the direction of some i -th basis vector e_i :

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*(0, 0)}{t} = \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i}$$

From the inequality Equation 1 and taking the limit $t \rightarrow 0$ with $t > 0$ we have

$$\frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*}{t} \geq -\lambda_i^* \rightarrow \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \geq -\lambda_i^*$$

For the negative $t < 0$ we have:

$$\frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*}{t} \leq -\lambda_i^* \rightarrow \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \leq -\lambda_i^*$$

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

$$\lambda_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \quad \nu_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial v_i} \quad (2)$$

To show this result we consider the directional derivative of $p^*(u, v)$ along the direction of some i -th basis vector e_i :

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*(0, 0)}{t} = \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i}$$

From the inequality Equation 1 and taking the limit $t \rightarrow 0$ with $t > 0$ we have

$$\frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*}{t} \geq -\lambda_i^* \rightarrow \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \geq -\lambda_i^*$$

For the negative $t < 0$ we have:

$$\frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*}{t} \leq -\lambda_i^* \rightarrow \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \leq -\lambda_i^*$$

The same idea can be used to establish the fact about v_i . The local sensitivity result Equation 2 provides a way to understand the impact of constraints on the optimal solution x^* of an optimization problem. If a constraint $f_i(x^*)$ is negative at x^* , it's not affecting the optimal solution, meaning small changes to this constraint won't alter the optimal value. In this case, the corresponding optimal Lagrange multiplier will be zero, as per the principle of complementary slackness.

Local sensitivity

Suppose now that $p^*(u, v)$ is differentiable at $u = 0, v = 0$.

$$\lambda_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \quad \nu_i^* = -\frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial v_i} \quad (2)$$

To show this result we consider the directional derivative of $p^*(u, v)$ along the direction of some i -th basis vector e_i :

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*(0, 0)}{t} = \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i}$$

From the inequality Equation 1 and taking the limit $t \rightarrow 0$ with $t > 0$ we have

$$\frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*}{t} \geq -\lambda_i^* \rightarrow \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \geq -\lambda_i^*$$

For the negative $t < 0$ we have:

$$\frac{p^*(te_i, 0) - p^*}{t} \leq -\lambda_i^* \rightarrow \frac{\partial p^*(0, 0)}{\partial u_i} \leq -\lambda_i^*$$

The same idea can be used to establish the fact about v_i . The local sensitivity result Equation 2 provides a way to understand the impact of constraints on the optimal solution x^* of an optimization problem. If a constraint $f_i(x^*)$ is negative at x^* , it's not affecting the optimal solution, meaning small changes to this constraint won't alter the optimal value. In this case, the corresponding optimal Lagrange multiplier will be zero, as per the principle of complementary slackness.

However, if $f_i(x^*) = 0$, meaning the constraint is precisely met at the optimum, then the situation is different. The value of the i -th optimal Lagrange multiplier, λ_i^* , gives us insight into how 'sensitive' or 'active' this constraint is. A small λ_i^* indicates that slight adjustments to the constraint won't significantly affect the optimal value. Conversely, a large λ_i^* implies that even minor changes to the constraint can have a significant impact on the optimal solution.

Applications

Solving the primal via the dual

An important consequence of stationarity: under strong duality, given a dual solution λ^*, ν^* , any primal solution x^* solves

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} f_0(x) + \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i^* f_i(x) + \sum_{i=1}^p \nu_i^* h_i(x)$$

Often, solutions of this unconstrained problem can be expressed **explicitly**, giving an explicit characterization of primal solutions from dual solutions.

Furthermore, suppose the solution of this problem is unique; then it must be the primal solution x^* .

This can be very helpful when the dual is easier to solve than the primal.

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

where each $f_i(x_i) = \frac{1}{2}c_i x_i^2$ (smooth and strictly convex).

The dual function:

$$g(\nu) = \min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) + \nu(b - a^T x)$$

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

where each $f_i(x_i) = \frac{1}{2}c_i x_i^2$ (smooth and strictly convex).

The dual function:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\nu) &= \min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) + \nu(b - a^T x) \\ &= b\nu + \sum_{i=1}^n \min_{x_i} \{f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu x_i\} \end{aligned}$$

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

where each $f_i(x_i) = \frac{1}{2}c_i x_i^2$ (smooth and strictly convex).

The dual function:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\nu) &= \min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) + \nu(b - a^T x) \\ &= b\nu + \sum_{i=1}^n \min_{x_i} \{f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu x_i\} \\ &= b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu), \end{aligned}$$

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

where each $f_i(x_i) = \frac{1}{2}c_i x_i^2$ (smooth and strictly convex).

The dual function:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\nu) &= \min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) + \nu(b - a^T x) \\ &= b\nu + \sum_{i=1}^n \min_{x_i} \{f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu x_i\} \\ &= b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu), \end{aligned}$$

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

where each $f_i(x_i) = \frac{1}{2}c_i x_i^2$ (smooth and strictly convex).

The dual function:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\nu) &= \min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) + \nu(b - a^T x) \\ &= b\nu + \sum_{i=1}^n \min_{x_i} \{f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu x_i\} \\ &= b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu), \end{aligned}$$

where each $f_i^*(y) = \frac{1}{2c_i} y^2$, called the conjugate of f_i .

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

where each $f_i(x_i) = \frac{1}{2}c_i x_i^2$ (smooth and strictly convex).

The dual function:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\nu) &= \min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) + \nu(b - a^T x) \\ &= b\nu + \sum_{i=1}^n \min_{x_i} \{f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu x_i\} \\ &= b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu), \end{aligned}$$

where each $f_i^*(y) = \frac{1}{2c_i} y^2$, called the conjugate of f_i .

Therefore the dual problem is:

$$\max_{\nu} b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \min_{\nu} \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu) - b\nu$$

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

where each $f_i(x_i) = \frac{1}{2}c_i x_i^2$ (smooth and strictly convex).

The dual function:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\nu) &= \min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) + \nu(b - a^T x) \\ &= b\nu + \sum_{i=1}^n \min_{x_i} \{f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu x_i\} \\ &= b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu), \end{aligned}$$

where each $f_i^*(y) = \frac{1}{2c_i} y^2$, called the conjugate of f_i .

Therefore the dual problem is:

$$\max_{\nu} b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \min_{\nu} \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu) - b\nu$$

This is a convex minimization problem with a scalar variable—much easier to solve than the primal.

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

where each $f_i(x_i) = \frac{1}{2}c_i x_i^2$ (smooth and strictly convex).

The dual function:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\nu) &= \min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) + \nu(b - a^T x) \\ &= b\nu + \sum_{i=1}^n \min_{x_i} \{f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu x_i\} \\ &= b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu), \end{aligned}$$

where each $f_i^*(y) = \frac{1}{2c_i} y^2$, called the conjugate of f_i .

Therefore the dual problem is:

$$\max_{\nu} b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \min_{\nu} \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu) - b\nu$$

This is a convex minimization problem with a scalar variable—much easier to solve than the primal.

Given ν^* , the primal solution x^* solves:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n (f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu^* x_i)$$

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

where each $f_i(x_i) = \frac{1}{2}c_i x_i^2$ (smooth and strictly convex).

The dual function:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\nu) &= \min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) + \nu(b - a^T x) \\ &= b\nu + \sum_{i=1}^n \min_{x_i} \{f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu x_i\} \\ &= b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu), \end{aligned}$$

where each $f_i^*(y) = \frac{1}{2c_i} y^2$, called the conjugate of f_i .

Therefore the dual problem is:

$$\max_{\nu} b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \min_{\nu} \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu) - b\nu$$

This is a convex minimization problem with a scalar variable—much easier to solve than the primal.

Given ν^* , the primal solution x^* solves:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n (f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu^* x_i)$$

The strict convexity of each f_i implies that this has a unique solution, namely x^* , which we compute by solving $f_i'(x_i) = a_i \nu^*$ for each i .

Solving the primal via the dual

For example, consider:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) \quad \text{subject to} \quad a^T x = b$$

where each $f_i(x_i) = \frac{1}{2}c_i x_i^2$ (smooth and strictly convex).

The dual function:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\nu) &= \min_x \sum_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i) + \nu(b - a^T x) \\ &= b\nu + \sum_{i=1}^n \min_{x_i} \{f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu x_i\} \\ &= b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu), \end{aligned}$$

where each $f_i^*(y) = \frac{1}{2c_i} y^2$, called the conjugate of f_i .

Therefore the dual problem is:

$$\max_{\nu} b\nu - \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \min_{\nu} \sum_{i=1}^n f_i^*(a_i \nu) - b\nu$$

This is a convex minimization problem with a scalar variable—much easier to solve than the primal.

Given ν^* , the primal solution x^* solves:

$$\min_x \sum_{i=1}^n (f_i(x_i) - a_i \nu^* x_i)$$

The strict convexity of each f_i implies that this has a unique solution, namely x^* , which we compute by solving $f'_i(x_i) = a_i \nu^*$ for each i .

This gives:

$$x_i^* = \frac{a_i \nu^*}{c_i}.$$

Mixed strategies for matrix games

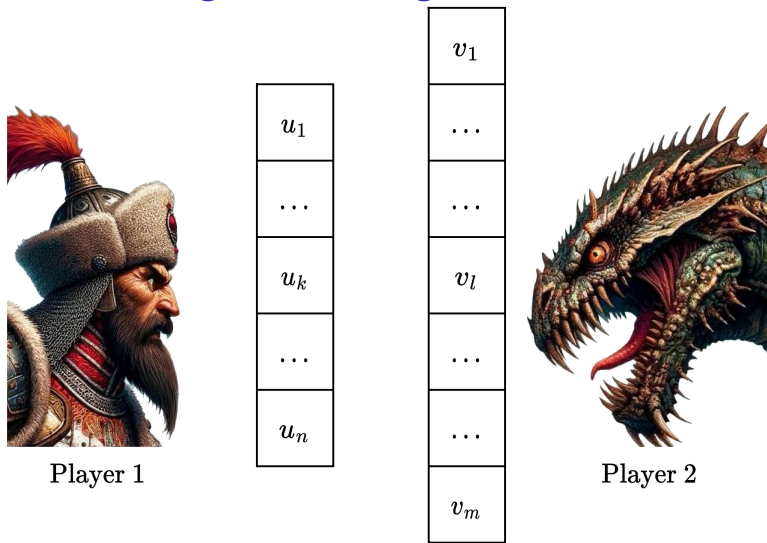


Figure 2: The scheme of a mixed strategy matrix game

Mixed strategies for matrix games



Player 1

u_1
$\dots$
u_k
$\dots$
u_n

v_1
$\dots$
$\dots$
v_l
$\dots$
$\dots$
v_m



Player 2

In zero-sum matrix games, players 1 and 2 choose actions from sets $\{1, \dots, n\}$ and $\{1, \dots, m\}$, respectively. The outcome is a payment from player 1 to player 2, determined by a payoff matrix $P \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times m}$. Each player aims to use mixed strategies, choosing actions according to a probability distribution: player 1 uses probabilities u_k for each action i , and player 2 uses v_l .

Figure 2: The scheme of a mixed strategy matrix game

Mixed strategies for matrix games



Player 1

u_1
$\dots$
u_k
$\dots$
u_n

v_1
$\dots$
$\dots$
v_l
$\dots$
$\dots$
v_m



Player 2

In zero-sum matrix games, players 1 and 2 choose actions from sets $\{1, \dots, n\}$ and $\{1, \dots, m\}$, respectively. The outcome is a payment from player 1 to player 2, determined by a payoff matrix $P \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times m}$. Each player aims to use mixed strategies, choosing actions according to a probability distribution: player 1 uses probabilities u_k for each action i , and player 2 uses v_l . The expected payoff from player 1 to player 2 is given by $\sum_{k=1}^n \sum_{l=1}^m u_k v_l P_{kl} = u^T P v$. Player 1 seeks to minimize this expected payoff, while player 2 aims to maximize it.

Figure 2: The scheme of a mixed strategy matrix game

Mixed strategies for matrix games. Player 1's Perspective



Player 1

u_1
$\dots$
u_k
$\dots$
u_n

Assuming player 2 knows player 1's strategy u , player 2 will choose v to maximize $u^T P v$. The worst-case expected payoff is thus:

$$\max_{v \geq 0, 1^T v = 1} u^T P v = \max_{i=1, \dots, m} (P^T u)_i$$

Mixed strategies for matrix games. Player 1's Perspective



Player 1

u_1
$\dots$
u_k
$\dots$
u_n

Assuming player 2 knows player 1's strategy u , player 2 will choose v to maximize $u^T P v$. The worst-case expected payoff is thus:

$$\max_{v \geq 0, 1^T v = 1} u^T P v = \max_{i=1, \dots, m} (P^T u)_i$$

Player 1's optimal strategy minimizes this worst-case payoff, leading to the optimization problem:

$$\begin{aligned} \min \quad & \max_{i=1, \dots, m} (P^T u)_i \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & u \geq 0 \\ & 1^T u = 1 \end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

This forms a convex optimization problem with the optimal value denoted as p_1^* .

Mixed strategies for matrix games. Player 2's Perspective

Conversely, if player 1 knows player 2's strategy v , the goal is to minimize $u^T P v$. This leads to:

$$\min_{u \geq 0, 1^T u = 1} u^T P v = \min_{i=1, \dots, n} (P v)_i$$



Player 2

v_1

...

...

v_l

...

...

v_m

Mixed strategies for matrix games. Player 2's Perspective

Conversely, if player 1 knows player 2's strategy v , the goal is to minimize $u^T P v$. This leads to:

$$\min_{u \geq 0, 1^T u = 1} u^T P v = \min_{i=1, \dots, n} (P v)_i$$

Player 2 then maximizes this to get the largest guaranteed payoff, solving the optimization problem:

$$\begin{aligned} \max \quad & \min_{i=1, \dots, n} (P v)_i \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & v \geq 0 \\ & 1^T v = 1 \end{aligned} \tag{4}$$

The optimal value here is p_2^* .



Player 2

v_1

...

...

v_l

...

...

v_m

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Formulating and Solving the Lagrange Dual

We approach problem Equation 3 by setting it up as a linear programming (LP) problem. The goal is to minimize a variable t , subject to certain constraints:

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Formulating and Solving the Lagrange Dual

We approach problem Equation 3 by setting it up as a linear programming (LP) problem. The goal is to minimize a variable t , subject to certain constraints:

1. $u \geq 0$,

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Formulating and Solving the Lagrange Dual

We approach problem Equation 3 by setting it up as a linear programming (LP) problem. The goal is to minimize a variable t , subject to certain constraints:

1. $u \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in u equals 1 ($1^T u = 1$),

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Formulating and Solving the Lagrange Dual

We approach problem Equation 3 by setting it up as a linear programming (LP) problem. The goal is to minimize a variable t , subject to certain constraints:

1. $u \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in u equals 1 ($1^T u = 1$),
3. $P^T u$ is less than or equal to t times a vector of ones ($P^T u \leq t\mathbf{1}$).

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Formulating and Solving the Lagrange Dual

We approach problem Equation 3 by setting it up as a linear programming (LP) problem. The goal is to minimize a variable t , subject to certain constraints:

1. $u \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in u equals 1 ($1^T u = 1$),
3. $P^T u$ is less than or equal to t times a vector of ones ($P^T u \leq t\mathbf{1}$).

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Formulating and Solving the Lagrange Dual

We approach problem Equation 3 by setting it up as a linear programming (LP) problem. The goal is to minimize a variable t , subject to certain constraints:

1. $u \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in u equals 1 ($1^T u = 1$),
3. $P^T u$ is less than or equal to t times a vector of ones ($P^T u \leq t\mathbf{1}$).

Here, t is an additional variable in the real numbers ($t \in \mathbb{R}$).

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Formulating and Solving the Lagrange Dual

We approach problem Equation 3 by setting it up as a linear programming (LP) problem. The goal is to minimize a variable t , subject to certain constraints:

1. $u \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in u equals 1 ($1^T u = 1$),
3. $P^T u$ is less than or equal to t times a vector of ones ($P^T u \leq t\mathbf{1}$).

Here, t is an additional variable in the real numbers ($t \in \mathbb{R}$).

Constructing the Lagrangian

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Formulating and Solving the Lagrange Dual

We approach problem Equation 3 by setting it up as a linear programming (LP) problem. The goal is to minimize a variable t , subject to certain constraints:

1. $u \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in u equals 1 ($1^T u = 1$),
3. $P^T u$ is less than or equal to t times a vector of ones ($P^T u \leq t\mathbf{1}$).

Here, t is an additional variable in the real numbers ($t \in \mathbb{R}$).

Constructing the Lagrangian

We introduce multipliers for the constraints: λ for $P^T u \leq t\mathbf{1}$, μ for $u \geq 0$, and ν for $1^T u = 1$. The Lagrangian is then formed as:

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Formulating and Solving the Lagrange Dual

We approach problem Equation 3 by setting it up as a linear programming (LP) problem. The goal is to minimize a variable t , subject to certain constraints:

1. $u \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in u equals 1 ($1^T u = 1$),
3. $P^T u$ is less than or equal to t times a vector of ones ($P^T u \leq t\mathbf{1}$).

Here, t is an additional variable in the real numbers ($t \in \mathbb{R}$).

Constructing the Lagrangian

We introduce multipliers for the constraints: λ for $P^T u \leq t\mathbf{1}$, μ for $u \geq 0$, and ν for $1^T u = 1$. The Lagrangian is then formed as:

$$L = t + \lambda^T(P^T u - t\mathbf{1}) - \mu^T u + \nu(1 - 1^T u) = \nu + (1 - 1^T \lambda)t + (P\lambda - \nu\mathbf{1} - \mu)^T u$$

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Duality and Equivalence

It's generally advantageous to know the opponent's strategy, but surprisingly, in mixed strategy matrix games, this advantage disappears. The key lies in duality: the problems above are Lagrange duals. By formulating player 1's problem as a linear program and introducing Lagrange multipliers, we find that the dual problem matches player 2's problem. Due to strong duality in feasible linear programs, $p_1^* = p_2^*$, showing no advantage in knowing the opponent's strategy.

Formulating and Solving the Lagrange Dual

We approach problem Equation 3 by setting it up as a linear programming (LP) problem. The goal is to minimize a variable t , subject to certain constraints:

1. $u \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in u equals 1 ($1^T u = 1$),
3. $P^T u$ is less than or equal to t times a vector of ones ($P^T u \leq t\mathbf{1}$).

Here, t is an additional variable in the real numbers ($t \in \mathbb{R}$).

Constructing the Lagrangian

We introduce multipliers for the constraints: λ for $P^T u \leq t\mathbf{1}$, μ for $u \geq 0$, and ν for $1^T u = 1$. The Lagrangian is then formed as:

$$L = t + \lambda^T(P^T u - t\mathbf{1}) - \mu^T u + \nu(1 - 1^T u) = \nu + (1 - 1^T \lambda)t + (P\lambda - \nu\mathbf{1} - \mu)^T u$$

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

The dual function $g(\lambda, \mu, \nu)$ is defined as:

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

The dual function $g(\lambda, \mu, \nu)$ is defined as:

$$g(\lambda, \mu, \nu) = \begin{cases} \nu & \text{if } \mathbf{1}^T \lambda = 1 \text{ and } P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

The dual function $g(\lambda, \mu, \nu)$ is defined as:

$$g(\lambda, \mu, \nu) = \begin{cases} \nu & \text{if } 1^T \lambda = 1 \text{ and } P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Solving the Dual Problem

The dual problem seeks to maximize ν under the following conditions:

1. $\lambda \geq 0$,

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

The dual function $g(\lambda, \mu, \nu)$ is defined as:

$$g(\lambda, \mu, \nu) = \begin{cases} \nu & \text{if } 1^T \lambda = 1 \text{ and } P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Solving the Dual Problem

The dual problem seeks to maximize ν under the following conditions:

1. $\lambda \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in λ equals 1 ($1^T \lambda = 1$),

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

The dual function $g(\lambda, \mu, \nu)$ is defined as:

$$g(\lambda, \mu, \nu) = \begin{cases} \nu & \text{if } 1^T \lambda = 1 \text{ and } P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Solving the Dual Problem

The dual problem seeks to maximize ν under the following conditions:

1. $\lambda \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in λ equals 1 ($1^T \lambda = 1$),
3. $\mu \geq 0$,

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

The dual function $g(\lambda, \mu, \nu)$ is defined as:

$$g(\lambda, \mu, \nu) = \begin{cases} \nu & \text{if } 1^T \lambda = 1 \text{ and } P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Solving the Dual Problem

The dual problem seeks to maximize ν under the following conditions:

1. $\lambda \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in λ equals 1 ($1^T \lambda = 1$),
3. $\mu \geq 0$,
4. $P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu$.

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

The dual function $g(\lambda, \mu, \nu)$ is defined as:

$$g(\lambda, \mu, \nu) = \begin{cases} \nu & \text{if } 1^T \lambda = 1 \text{ and } P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Solving the Dual Problem

The dual problem seeks to maximize ν under the following conditions:

1. $\lambda \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in λ equals 1 ($1^T \lambda = 1$),
3. $\mu \geq 0$,
4. $P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu$.

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

The dual function $g(\lambda, \mu, \nu)$ is defined as:

$$g(\lambda, \mu, \nu) = \begin{cases} \nu & \text{if } 1^T \lambda = 1 \text{ and } P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Solving the Dual Problem

The dual problem seeks to maximize ν under the following conditions:

1. $\lambda \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in λ equals 1 ($1^T \lambda = 1$),
3. $\mu \geq 0$,
4. $P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu$.

Upon eliminating μ , we obtain the Lagrange dual of Equation 3:

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

The dual function $g(\lambda, \mu, \nu)$ is defined as:

$$g(\lambda, \mu, \nu) = \begin{cases} \nu & \text{if } 1^T \lambda = 1 \text{ and } P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Solving the Dual Problem

The dual problem seeks to maximize ν under the following conditions:

1. $\lambda \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in λ equals 1 ($1^T \lambda = 1$),
3. $\mu \geq 0$,
4. $P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu$.

Upon eliminating μ , we obtain the Lagrange dual of Equation 3:

$$\begin{aligned} & \max \nu \\ & \text{s.t. } \lambda \geq 0 \\ & 1^T \lambda = 1 \\ & P\lambda \geq \nu \mathbf{1} \end{aligned}$$

Mixed strategies for matrix games

Defining the Dual Function

The dual function $g(\lambda, \mu, \nu)$ is defined as:

$$g(\lambda, \mu, \nu) = \begin{cases} \nu & \text{if } 1^T \lambda = 1 \text{ and } P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu \\ -\infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Solving the Dual Problem

The dual problem seeks to maximize ν under the following conditions:

1. $\lambda \geq 0$,
2. The sum of elements in λ equals 1 ($1^T \lambda = 1$),
3. $\mu \geq 0$,
4. $P\lambda - \nu \mathbf{1} = \mu$.

Upon eliminating μ , we obtain the Lagrange dual of Equation 3:

$$\begin{aligned} & \max \nu \\ & \text{s.t. } \lambda \geq 0 \\ & 1^T \lambda = 1 \\ & P\lambda \geq \nu \mathbf{1} \end{aligned}$$

Conclusion

This formulation shows that the Lagrange dual problem is equivalent to problem Equation 4. Given the feasibility of these linear programs, strong duality holds, meaning the optimal values of Equation 3 and Equation 4 are equal.

A nonconvex quadratic problem with strong duality

On rare occasions strong duality obtains for a nonconvex problem. As an important example, we consider the problem of minimizing a nonconvex quadratic function over the unit ball

A nonconvex quadratic problem with strong duality

On rare occasions strong duality obtains for a nonconvex problem. As an important example, we consider the problem of minimizing a nonconvex quadratic function over the unit ball

$$\begin{aligned} x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } x^\top x &\leq 1 \end{aligned}$$

A nonconvex quadratic problem with strong duality

On rare occasions strong duality obtains for a nonconvex problem. As an important example, we consider the problem of minimizing a nonconvex quadratic function over the unit ball

$$\begin{aligned} x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } x^\top x &\leq 1 \end{aligned}$$

where $A \in \mathbb{S}^n$, $A \not\preceq 0$ and $b \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Since $A \not\preceq 0$, this is not a convex problem. This problem is sometimes called the trust region problem, and arises in minimizing a second-order approximation of a function over the unit ball, which is the region in which the approximation is assumed to be approximately valid.

A nonconvex quadratic problem with strong duality

On rare occasions strong duality obtains **Solution** for a nonconvex problem. As an important example, we consider the problem of minimizing a nonconvex quadratic function over the unit ball

$$\begin{aligned} x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } x^\top x &\leq 1 \end{aligned}$$

where $A \in \mathbb{S}^n$, $A \not\preceq 0$ and $b \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Since $A \not\preceq 0$, this is not a convex problem. This problem is sometimes called the trust region problem, and arises in minimizing a second-order approximation of a function over the unit ball, which is the region in which the approximation is assumed to be approximately valid.

A nonconvex quadratic problem with strong duality

On rare occasions strong duality obtains for a nonconvex problem. As an important example, we consider the problem of minimizing a nonconvex quadratic function over the unit ball

Solution

Lagrangian and dual function

$$L(x, \lambda) = x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x + \lambda(x^\top x - 1) = x^\top (A + \lambda I)x + 2b^\top x - \lambda$$

$$x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

$$\text{s.t. } x^\top x \leq 1$$

where $A \in \mathbb{S}^n$, $A \not\preceq 0$ and $b \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Since $A \not\preceq 0$, this is not a convex problem. This problem is sometimes called the trust region problem, and arises in minimizing a second-order approximation of a function over the unit ball, which is the region in which the approximation is assumed to be approximately valid.

A nonconvex quadratic problem with strong duality

On rare occasions strong duality obtains for a nonconvex problem. As an important example, we consider the problem of minimizing a nonconvex quadratic function over the unit ball

Solution

Lagrangian and dual function

$$L(x, \lambda) = x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x + \lambda(x^\top x - 1) = x^\top (A + \lambda I)x + 2b^\top x - \lambda$$

$$\begin{aligned} x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } x^\top x &\leq 1 \end{aligned}$$

$$g(\lambda) = \begin{cases} -b^\top (A + \lambda I)^\dagger b - \lambda & \text{if } A + \lambda I \succeq 0 \\ -\infty, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

where $A \in \mathbb{S}^n$, $A \not\succeq 0$ and $b \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Since $A \not\succeq 0$, this is not a convex problem. This problem is sometimes called the trust region problem, and arises in minimizing a second-order approximation of a function over the unit ball, which is the region in which the approximation is assumed to be approximately valid.

A nonconvex quadratic problem with strong duality

On rare occasions strong duality obtains for a nonconvex problem. As an important example, we consider the problem of minimizing a nonconvex quadratic function over the unit ball

Solution

Lagrangian and dual function

$$L(x, \lambda) = x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x + \lambda(x^\top x - 1) = x^\top (A + \lambda I)x + 2b^\top x - \lambda$$

$$\begin{aligned} x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } x^\top x &\leq 1 \end{aligned}$$

$$g(\lambda) = \begin{cases} -b^\top (A + \lambda I)^\dagger b - \lambda & \text{if } A + \lambda I \succeq 0 \\ -\infty, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Dual problem:

$$\begin{aligned} -b^\top (A + \lambda I)^\dagger b - \lambda &\rightarrow \max_{\lambda \in \mathbb{R}} \\ \text{s.t. } A + \lambda I &\succeq 0 \end{aligned}$$

where $A \in \mathbb{S}^n$, $A \not\preceq 0$ and $b \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Since $A \not\preceq 0$, this is not a convex problem. This problem is sometimes called the trust region problem, and arises in minimizing a second-order approximation of a function over the unit ball, which is the region in which the approximation is assumed to be approximately valid.

A nonconvex quadratic problem with strong duality

On rare occasions strong duality obtains for a nonconvex problem. As an important example, we consider the problem of minimizing a nonconvex quadratic function over the unit ball

Solution

Lagrangian and dual function

$$L(x, \lambda) = x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x + \lambda(x^\top x - 1) = x^\top (A + \lambda I)x + 2b^\top x - \lambda$$

$$\begin{aligned} x^\top Ax + 2b^\top x &\rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \\ \text{s.t. } x^\top x &\leq 1 \end{aligned}$$

$$g(\lambda) = \begin{cases} -b^\top (A + \lambda I)^\dagger b - \lambda & \text{if } A + \lambda I \succeq 0 \\ -\infty, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Dual problem:

where $A \in \mathbb{S}^n$, $A \not\preceq 0$ and $b \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Since $A \not\preceq 0$, this is not a convex problem. This problem is sometimes called the trust region problem, and arises in minimizing a second-order approximation of a function over the unit ball, which is the region in which the approximation is assumed to be approximately valid.

$$\begin{aligned} -b^\top (A + \lambda I)^\dagger b - \lambda &\rightarrow \max_{\lambda \in \mathbb{R}} \\ \text{s.t. } A + \lambda I &\succeq 0 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} -\sum_{i=1}^n \frac{(q_i^\top b)^2}{\lambda_i + \lambda} - \lambda &\rightarrow \max_{\lambda \in \mathbb{R}} \\ \text{s.t. } \lambda &\geq -\lambda_{\min}(A) \end{aligned}$$

References

- Lecture on KKT conditions (very intuitive explanation) in the course “Elements of Statistical Learning” @ KTH.

References

- Lecture on KKT conditions (very intuitive explanation) in the course “Elements of Statistical Learning” @ KTH.
- One-line proof of KKT

References

- Lecture on KKT conditions (very intuitive explanation) in the course “Elements of Statistical Learning” @ KTH.
- One-line proof of KKT
- On the Second Order Optimality Conditions for Optimization Problems with Inequality Constraints

References

- Lecture on KKT conditions (very intuitive explanation) in the course “Elements of Statistical Learning” @ KTH.
- One-line proof of KKT
- On the Second Order Optimality Conditions for Optimization Problems with Inequality Constraints
- On Second Order Optimality Conditions in Nonlinear Optimization

References

- Lecture on KKT conditions (very intuitive explanation) in the course “Elements of Statistical Learning” @ KTH.
- One-line proof of KKT
- On the Second Order Optimality Conditions for Optimization Problems with Inequality Constraints
- On Second Order Optimality Conditions in Nonlinear Optimization
- Numerical Optimization by Jorge Nocedal and Stephen J. Wright.

References

- Lecture on KKT conditions (very intuitive explanation) in the course “Elements of Statistical Learning” @ KTH.
- One-line proof of KKT
- On the Second Order Optimality Conditions for Optimization Problems with Inequality Constraints
- On Second Order Optimality Conditions in Nonlinear Optimization
- Numerical Optimization by Jorge Nocedal and Stephen J. Wright.
- Duality Uses and Correspondences lecture by Ryan Tibshirani course.